



Photographs by: SUVASHIS MULLICK/www.indiatodayimages.com

of over 1,300 and is looking ahead at a turnover to the tune of Rs 1,000 crore by 2010.

Ruia says a lot had to change in Jessop since his Group took over. He says initially there was a lot of resistance as many thought the group took over Jessop for cheap gains and was not really interested in rebuilding it. "We took into account internal and external factors, financial feasibility and our capability. We made changes to streamline the functioning of the company and the condition of the factory workers. While we discarded all contract labourers, not a single Jessop worker was laid off. Even today, we have not modernised the plant completely so that the existing manpower does not become

redundant," he says.

Today, Jessop's product file includes steel bridges, industrial buildings, cranes, railway rolling stock like passenger coaches, EMU coaches and wagons, construction equipment and mining machinery. The gross turnover of the company in the past 10 years has increased from Rs 53.36 crore in 1997-98 to Rs 163 crore in 2007-2008.

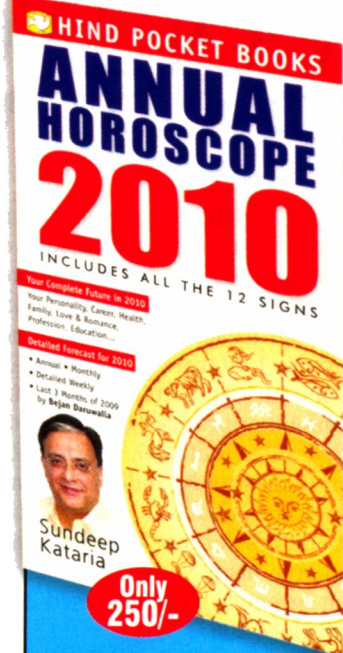
Known for its association with the Railways, the company has the capacity to produce 500 wagons, 1,500 bogies and 1,500 couplers per month, and yet there is a shortfall to meet the demand.

While it has achieved many milestones in the past, Jessop seems all set to continue with its tradition of excellence.

by Elora Sen

44 per cent
bridges of the
Indian Railways
are more than
100 years old.
There are about
1,28,000
bridges in all.

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